

Certified by its maker. Audited that day.

Tesla put a small number of Cybercabs into commercial service in Austin on September 3rd, 2026. The agency records no permanently attached conventional manual controls, naming brake pedal, gas pedal, steering wheel and mirrors.

INVESTIGATION	AQ26002
DATE OPENED	September 3rd, 2026
ACTION	Open Audit Query (AQ)
POPULATION	1,000 (Estimated)
DEPLOYED	a small number

An audit query is neither a defect investigation nor a recall.

PROBLEM DESCRIPTION

Examination of the process and technical data on which Tesla relied when certifying the Cybercab and related issues.

WHAT TESLA TOLD THE AGENCY

Tesla certified it and told the agency

"certified those Cybercab vehicles as compliant with all applicable Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards"

TESLA, AS THE AGENCY RECORDS IT



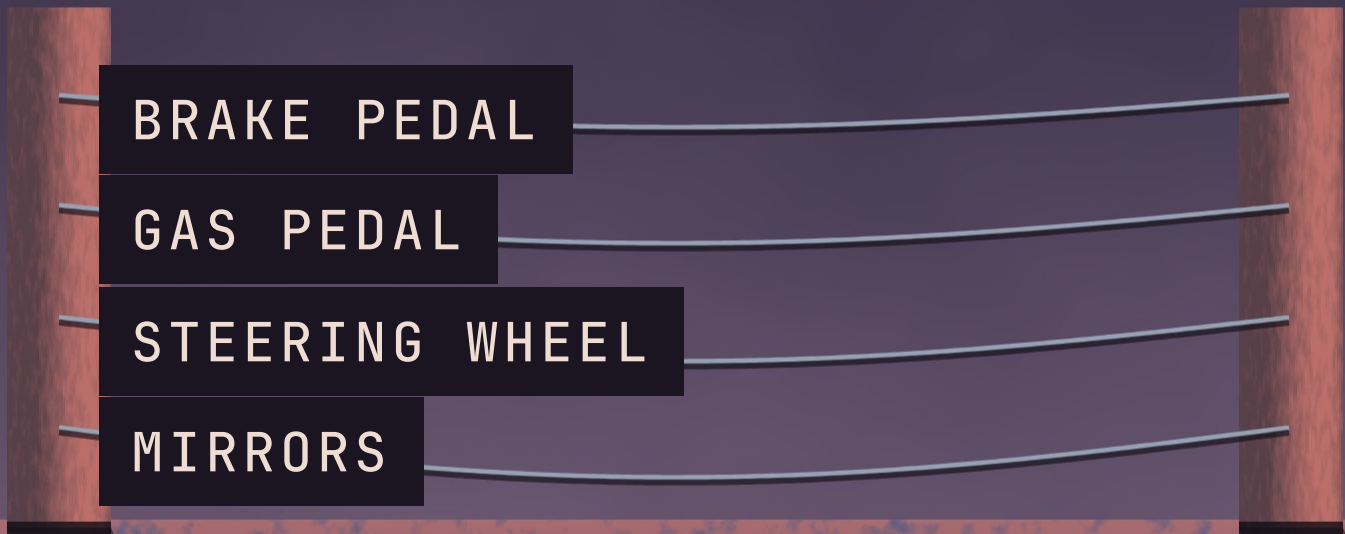
NHTSA's stated subject is the process and the technical data behind that sentence.

THE RULES ASSUME A DRIVER

PROPOSED, NOT IN FORCE

The Department of Transportation has proposed removing the manual-controls requirement for vehicles designed to drive themselves.

THE AGENCY RECORDS NO PERMANENTLY ATTACHED CONVENTIONAL MANUAL CONTROLS, NAMING



BRAKE PEDAL

GAS PEDAL

STEERING WHEEL

MIRRORS

Until that work is finished the existing standards remain in force.

This construction is not new

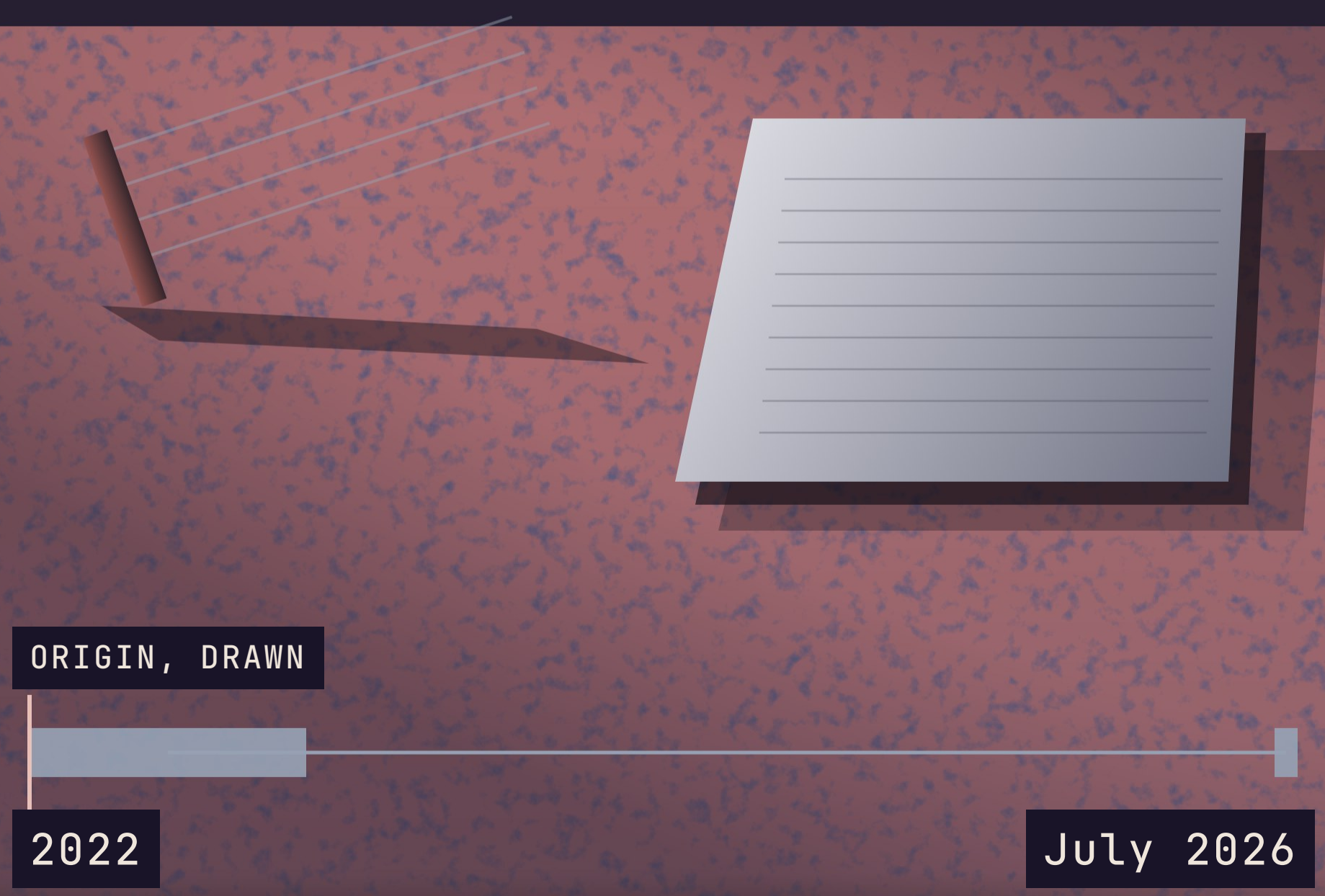
In 2022 Zoox self-certified a robotaxi that also has no steering wheel and no pedals.

THE ROUTE THROUGH

TEXAS AI DOCKET

FILED UNDER	49 CFR Part 555
STANDARDS COVERED	eight Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards
FINAL APPROVAL	July 2026

Zoox self-certified in 2022. It later filed for a temporary exemption under Part 555 and received final approval in July 2026.





The rules a reader is judged by
are themselves being rewritten.
The Cybercab is carrying riders
while that is still unfinished.

"NHTSA fully supports the safe development and deployment of automated vehicles. But as the federal regulator, we need to ensure that all of our laws are followed."

JONATHAN MORRISON, NHTSA ADMINISTRATOR

"plans to gradually expand commercial deployment of the Cybercab"

TESLA, AS THE AGENCY RECORDS IT

Nothing in this record says what happens next.

TWO DEPARTURES, ONE TRAILHEAD

September 3rd, 2026

One route has ruts. One started on September 3rd.

The audit is open. Read its resume by the number. Any interested person may petition NHTSA to decide whether a vehicle meets an applicable standard.